



10th Grade English Language Arts

English 2 (Florida course 1001340) · Full year, delivered as two semester sections · From the short story to Shakespeare: human nature, honest persuasion, and the cost of ambition

~4¼ hrs
per week
50 min/day, M–F

About this overview. This document is an example of how the course might be taught. More books are approved for this course than appear here, so scholars may see some variation in texts and projects from course to course, and between the live school and On-Demand. Each teacher also leans into their own strengths and passions; the structure, expectations, and time commitment below are representative of the course as designed.

10th Grade ELA moves from the compact craft of the short story to the grand scale of epic and tragedy. Scholars begin with nine classic short stories on desire, conscience, justice, and loss, then study chivalry and allegory in *The Once and Future King* alongside a serious unit on rhetoric: what makes an argument honest rather than manipulative. The spring brings lyric poetry, Homer's *Odyssey*, and a final quarter pairing *Julius Caesar* with *The Great Gatsby* to ask what happens when ambition replaces virtue. Each module ends in a capstone essay, and a year-end portfolio gathers the scholar's best work. Every week pairs literature lessons with grammar practice, a Quick Write, a quiz, and a VR experience tied to the reading.

THE YEAR AT A GLANCE — 4 MODULES · 36 WEEKS

Module · Theme	Weeks	Quarter	Texts & capstone
1 · Classical Foundations in Short Fiction — the story as a window into human nature	9	Q1	Nine stories: Soto, Hughes, Maupassant, Tan, Poe, Stephenson, Dahl, Saki + O. Henry, Collier; capstone: personal narrative essay (600–900 words)
2 · Chivalry, Allegory & Persuasion — how do heroes fail? what makes an argument honest?	9	Q2	<i>The Once and Future King</i> excerpts, medieval satire, Frost, nonfiction on rhetorical appeals and logical fallacies; capstone: argumentative essay (500–700 words)
3 · Poetry, Voice & the Hero's Journey — what does the hero's journey reveal about us?	9	Q3	The argument unit concludes; lyric poems by Herrick, Burns, Whitman, Robinson, H.D., Poe, and Spenser; <i>The Odyssey</i> (Cyclops, Sirens, Land of the Dead, Penelope's test); two-part capstone: argumentative essay + hero profile essay
4 · Power, Ambition & the American Myth — what happens when ambition replaces virtue?	9	Q4	<i>Julius Caesar</i> (3 weeks) and <i>The Great Gatsby</i> (4 weeks), then synthesis; capstone: comparative theme essay + portfolio presentation

A TYPICAL WEEK

Piece	What the scholar does (~50 min/day, M–F)
Lessons	Four literature lessons walk through the week's text with its historical context and craft focus.
Grammar	Two grammar lessons (ungraded practice) build conventions and style all year.
Quick Write	One graded Quick Write responds to the week's reading and feeds the module capstone.
VR	One VR experience on Optima's VR campus: scene reconstructions, debates, myth labs, <i>Gatsby's</i> mansion.
Quiz	A short weekly quiz checks the reading.

TIME COMMITMENT

250 minutes per week is the school's designated planning figure for this course: about 50 minutes a day, Monday through Friday. Reading and the Quick Write are the core of that time. **Capstone weeks** at the end of each module can run longer, and slower readers should budget extra time for *The Odyssey*, *Julius Caesar*, and *The Great Gatsby*.

GRADING AT A GLANCE (PER MODULE)

Work	Points	Notes
Quick Writes	9 × 25	Weekly writing, building toward the capstone
VR assignments	9 × 25	Completion + written reflection
Weekly quizzes	9 × 20	Reading checks
Capstone essay	75–90	One per module; Module 4 adds a 35-pt portfolio presentation

WHAT SCHOLARS NEED

- ▶ A computer with a web browser; short stories and poems are provided on or alongside the lesson pages, and the teacher provides the longer texts
- ▶ **VR headset** for Optima's VR campus: one VR experience per week
- ▶ OneDrive (Microsoft 365) for Quick Writes, capstone essays, and the year-end portfolio

THE WRITING ARC

- ▶ Narrative (Q1) → argument (Q2–Q3) → expository and comparative analysis (Q3–Q4)
- ▶ Each capstone is scaffolded by the module's Quick Writes and revised from feedback
- ▶ The year ends with a **portfolio presentation** of the scholar's best work

NOTES FOR FAMILIES

On-Demand (asynchronous). This course is designed for self-paced study with due dates for pacing. A teacher is available throughout for support, feedback on writing, and grading.

Live school. Scholars enrolled in the live school complete the same course in VR every school day with a teacher and classmates.